Experiment 9
Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

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Title
Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator – Student Admission Portal Application.

Aim
To explore the built-in analytics, interactive dashboard charts and report display options of the Student Admission Portal application in Zoho Creator, and to check the availability of AI-assisted (Zia) features in the application and its editor.

Objective
- To observe the KPI cards, charts and reports displayed on the application dashboard.
- To study the interactive behaviour of the pie chart and the column chart.
- To identify the built-in display formats available for a report.
- To check the Design and Workflow areas of the application editor for Zia / AI-assisted options.

Software / Tools Required
- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Student Admission Portal application created in Zoho Creator
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application and its editor

Introduction / Theory
AI-Assisted Features in Zoho Creator
AI-assisted features in a low-code platform are intended to help users build applications and understand their data with less manual effort. At a conceptual level, such features may assist with tasks such as generating insights from stored data, answering questions about data, or suggesting elements of an application. The availability of these features depends on the Zoho Creator edition, the plan of the account and the interface version in use.

Zia
Zia is the artificial-intelligence assistant of the Zoho ecosystem. Conceptually, Zia provides AI-driven capabilities, such as data insights and assistance in working with application data, within Zoho products. Whether and where Zia options appear in Zoho Creator depends on the account and plan.

Built-in Analytics and Dashboards
Zoho Creator provides built-in analytics through pages and dashboards, which present application data visually without external tools. A dashboard combines several components on one page so that the status of the application can be understood at a glance. The following components are commonly used:

Component	Purpose
KPI cards	Display a single key figure, such as a total or a count of records in a particular status.

241401129

Component	Purpose
Charts	Represent data graphically, for example pie charts for proportional distribution and column charts for comparison between categories.
Reports	Present records of a form in a structured manner, with columns for the fields of the form.
Interactive visualizations	Respond to user actions such as hovering, which displays the exact value represented by a chart segment or bar.

Report Display Formats

A report in Zoho Creator can be shown in more than one display format through the Show As option. Different formats present the same records in different ways, for instance as a list, on a calendar, along a timeline, in a spreadsheet layout or as a Kanban board, so that users can choose the format that suits the task.

Procedure

1 Open Zoho Creator and sign in. The home page lists the available applications.

2 Open the Student Admission Portal application and select **Access this application** to open it in its live (application) view.

3 Observe the dashboard (Home page). It contains the KPI cards, a pie chart, a column chart, an Under Review Status section and the All Application Report.

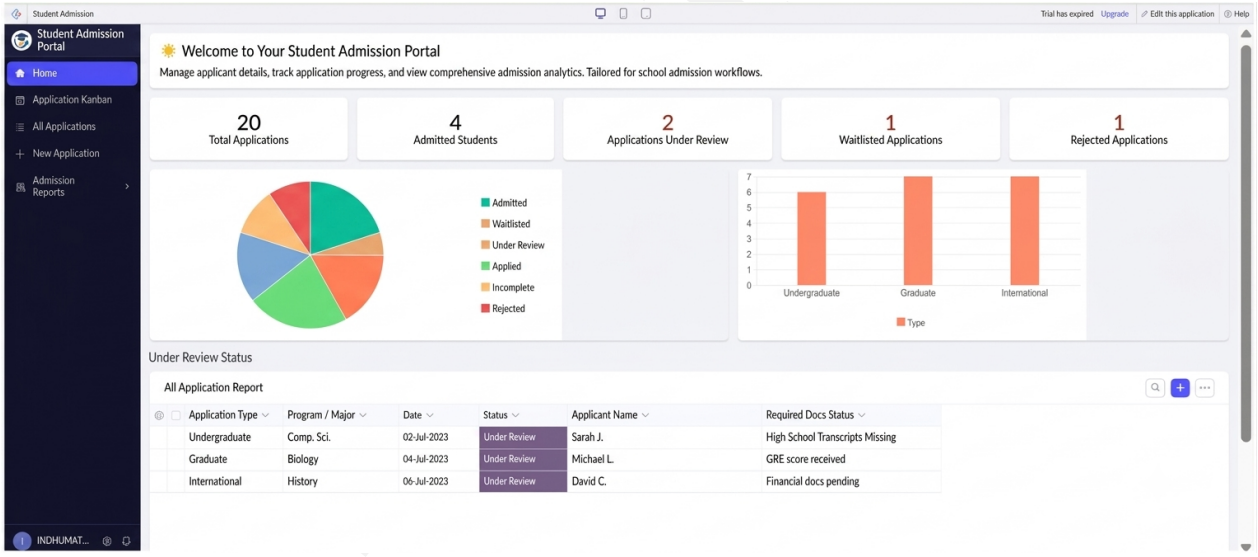


Figure 9.1: Student Admission Portal Dashboard with Comprehensive Analytics

4 Examine the KPI cards and record the values displayed: Total Applications – 20, Admitted Students – 4, Applications Under Review – 2, Waitlisted Applications – 1 and Rejected Applications – 1.

5 Examine the pie chart, which shows the distribution of applications by status. Its legend lists the status categories Admitted, Waitlisted, Under Review, Applied, Incomplete and Rejected.

6 Place the pointer over a segment of the pie chart. A tooltip is displayed showing the status and the exact count of applications in it.

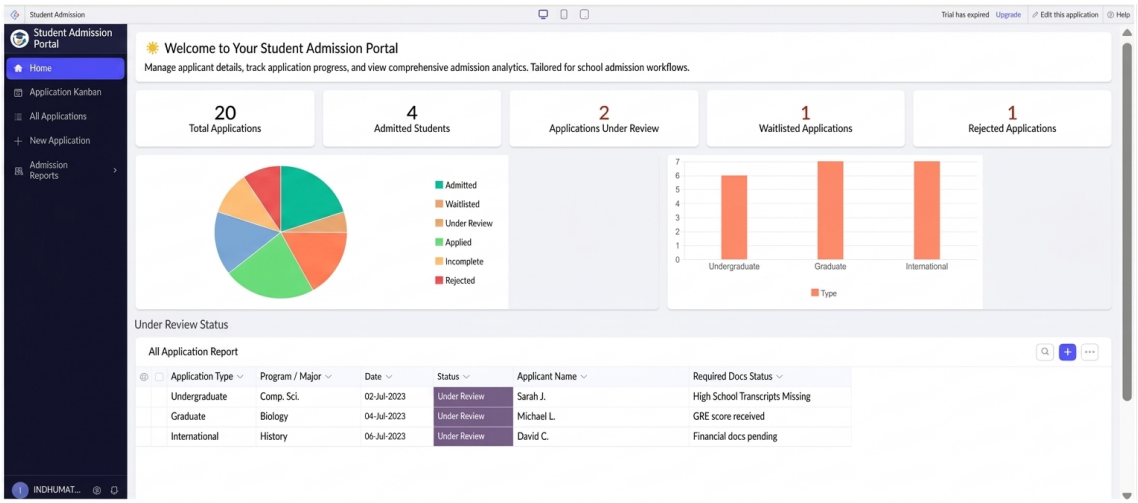


Figure 9.2: Interactive Pie Chart Showing Application Status

7 Examine the column chart, which shows the number of applications for each application type (Undergraduate, Graduate and International).

8 Place the pointer over a bar of the column chart. A tooltip is displayed showing Type – Undergraduate : 6.

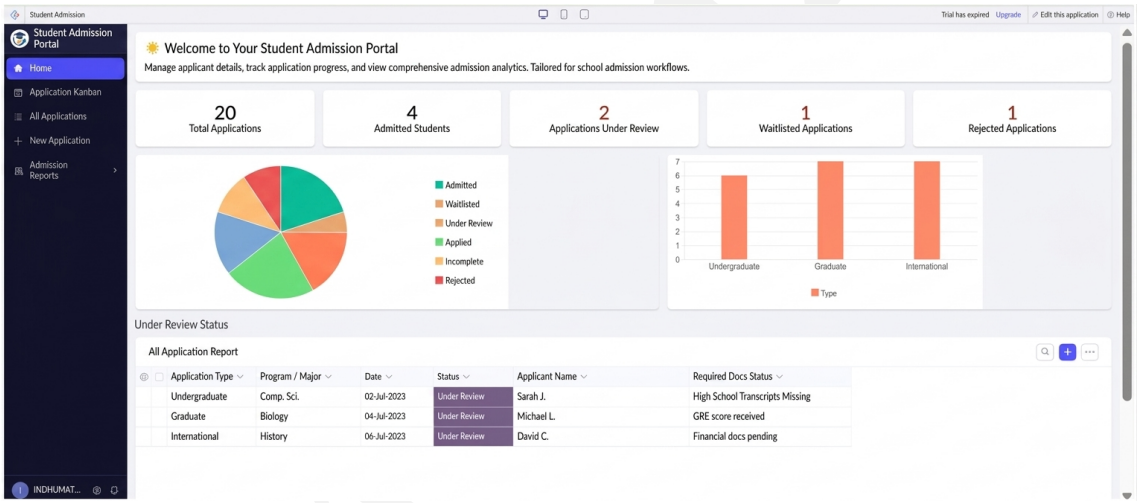


Figure 9.3: Interactive Column Chart Showing Application Type

9 Scroll to the All Application Report and open the options menu (three dots) at the top-right corner of the report.

10 Open the **Show As** menu and record the options available: List, Calendar, Timeline, Spreadsheet, Kanban and Import. The menu is only viewed; no report view is changed or saved.

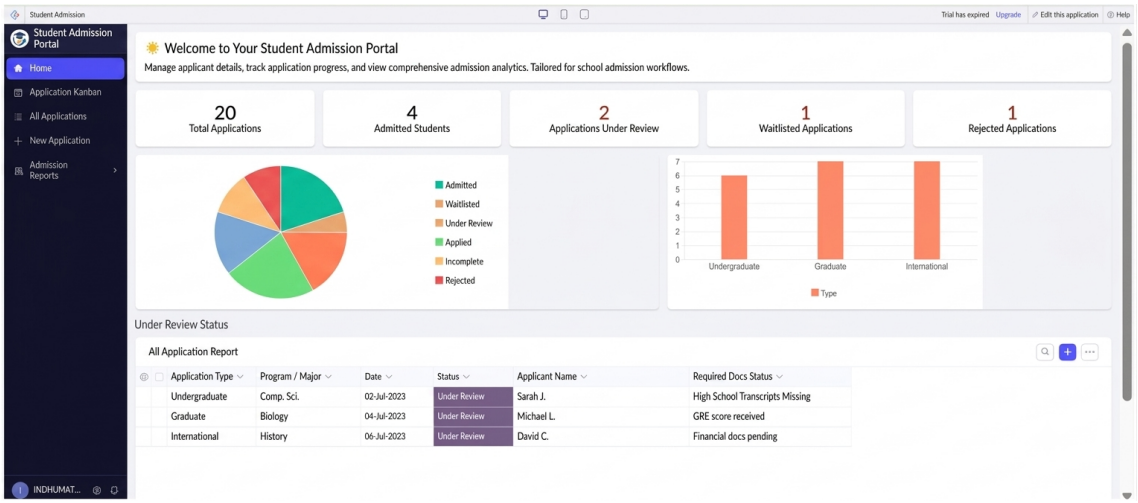


Figure 9.4: Built-in Report Views in the All Application Report

11 Select **Edit this application** to open the application editor, and check the Design area for any Zia, Analytics or AI-specific option.

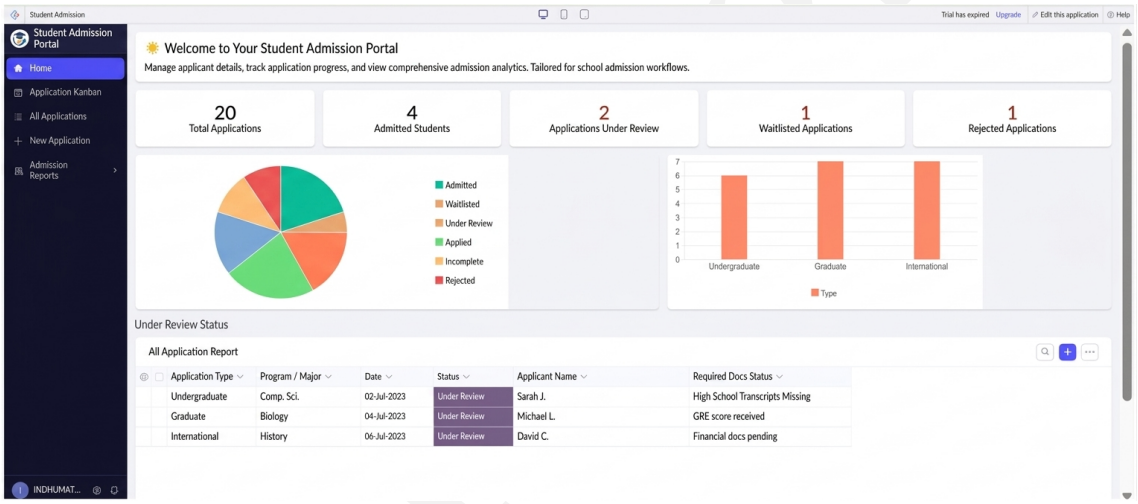


Figure 9.5: Zoho Creator Application Editor – Design Area

12 Check the Workflow section of the editor. Workflow and form-related options are available, but no Zia / AI analytics feature is present.

13 Note that the account displays “Trial has expired” with an Upgrade option, and record that Zia / AI-assisted functionality was not available in the current account / interface.

Dashboard Analytics

The KPI cards on the dashboard displayed the following values:

KPI	Value
Total Applications	20
Admitted Students	4
Applications Under Review	2
Waitlisted Applications	1
Rejected Applications	1

The All Application Report on the dashboard is organised under the columns Application Type, Program / Major, Date, Status, Applicant Name and Required Docs Status. The records visible in the report under the Under Review Status section are listed below.

Application Type	Program / Major	Date	Status	Applicant Name	Required Docs Status
Undergraduate	Comp. Sci.	02-Jul-2023	Under Review	Sarah J.	High School Transcripts Missing
Graduate	Biology	04-Jul-2023	Under Review	Michael L.	GRE score received
International	History	06-Jul-2023	Under Review	David C.	Financial docs pending

Interactive Chart Analysis

The charts on the dashboard respond to the pointer and display exact values on hovering.

Chart	Hover Result	Interpretation
Pie chart (application status)	Status – Admitted : 4	Four applications are in the Admitted status.
Column chart (application type)	Type – Undergraduate : 6	Six applications are of the type Undergraduate.

This shows that the dashboard charts provide interactive data details: the exact count behind a segment or bar can be read directly from the chart instead of being estimated visually.

Built-in Report Views

The Show As menu of the All Application Report listed the options below. The menu was only opened to explore the options; none of the views was applied, modified or saved. The List option carried a tick mark, indicating that it was the display format in use.

Option	General Description	Observation
List	Shows records as rows in a tabular list with a column for each field.	Listed; currently selected
Calendar	Places records on a calendar according to a date field.	Listed in menu
Timeline	Arranges records chronologically along a timeline.	Listed in menu

Option	General Description	Observation
Spreadsheet	Presents records in a grid layout similar to a spreadsheet.	Listed in menu
Kanban	Displays records as cards grouped in columns, typically by status.	Listed in menu
Import	Provides the option to bring data into the report's form from an external file.	Listed in menu

Zia / AI-Assisted Feature Exploration

The application and its editor were checked for Zia / AI-assisted functionality:

- **Design area:** inspected through the application editor (Figure 9.5). No Zia, Analytics or AI-specific option was visible.
- **Workflow section:** inspected. It contained workflow and form-related options, but no Zia / AI analytics feature was available.
- **Account status:** the account displayed "Trial has expired" with an Upgrade option.

Therefore, Zia / AI-assisted functionality was not available in the current account / interface. Zia was not used, configured or demonstrated in this experiment, and no AI-generated insights were obtained. The analytics demonstrated in this experiment are the built-in dashboard and reporting features of the application.

Result

The following were successfully carried out in the Student Admission Portal application:

- The dashboard KPI values (Total 20, Admitted 4, Under Review 2, Waitlisted 1, Rejected 1) were observed.
- The interactive pie chart (Status – Admitted : 4) and column chart (Type – Undergraduate : 6) were explored.
- The built-in report display options (List, Calendar, Timeline, Spreadsheet, Kanban and Import) were identified in the Show As menu.

The Design and Workflow areas were checked for Zia / AI-assisted features; however, no such option was available in the current account / interface because the trial had expired. Hence, Zia was not used in this experiment.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated the built-in analytics of Zoho Creator through the Student Admission Portal application. KPI cards summarise key figures, interactive charts reveal exact values on hovering, and the Show As menu offers several formats for viewing report data. These features help in monitoring student applications and admission progress without external analytical tools. The Zia / AI-assisted functionality could not be explored because it was not available in the current account / interface, where the trial had expired. The practical work therefore covered the built-in dashboard analytics, interactive charts and report-view options.

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